

Svelte **Review Cards**



Eight concepts an interviewer can probe and a beginner must own.
Read the question, cover the answer, answer aloud, then check the
code and the figure.

0 — The Render Vocabulary: scene parts, not boxes

VOCABULARY INDEX DESIGN SYSTEM

USE. This gallery is the drawable half of the design workflow: after CAST names the metaphor, assemble the scene from these components instead of inventing CSS. Every component is print-safe, deterministic in Chrome and Prince, and 130mm-safe. The gallery screenshots in `html/_shots/` are the visual menu — look before you build.

THE PARTS.

- `.env-dots` `.env-hatch` `.env-blueprint` — environments: the background joins the metaphor
- `.console` — a developer terminal, print-safe light version
- `.paper` — a printed page; `.paper.old` is yesterday's edition
- `.bldg` — an instance/building; pair with `.ghost` when demolished
- `.tray` — a queue or inbox holding `.tray-item`s
- `.stamp` — a rotated verdict tag (`.red` `.grn` `.blu`)
- `.badge` — a numbered circle for sequenced steps
- `.watermark` — a giant faded glyph behind content
- `.ghost` `.strike` — dead, destroyed, absent things
- `.wire` `.wire-tag` — connectors with inline labels; `.head` `.down` `.dashed`
- `.zone` `.zone-label` — a named dashed region
- `.lane` `.lane-label` — comparison rows with color-coded semantics

① **The rule.** Compose from this vocabulary first; reach for custom inline CSS only for gaps, and any gap used twice gets promoted into `metaphors.css`.

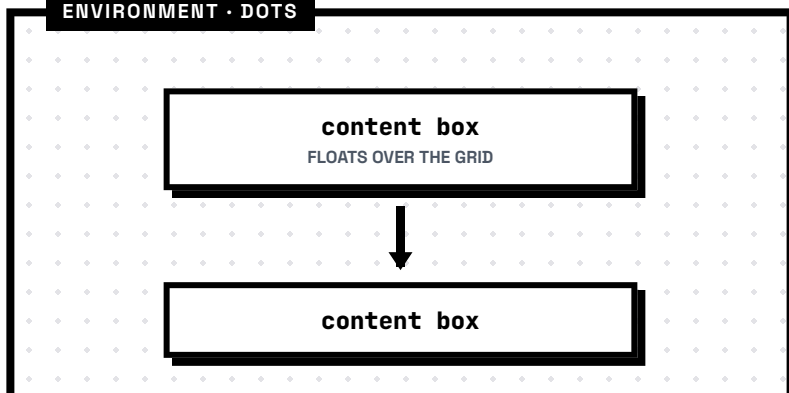
1 — Component: .env-dots

ENVIRONMENT TEXTURE

USE. A dotted grid on the diagram panel. The quietest environment: adds depth without stealing focus. Good default for flow scenes (wires, feeds, pipelines).

```
<div class="dg env-dots"> ... </div>
```

ENVIRONMENT · DOTS



① **Note.** Light enough to vanish on a monochrome printer while keeping the panel from looking empty.

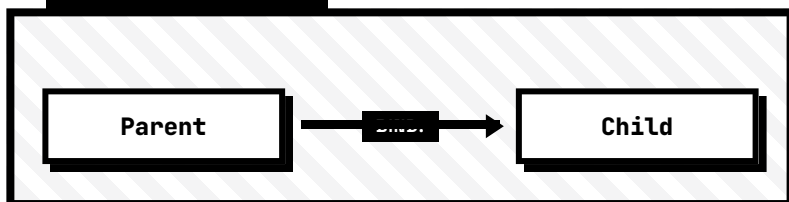
2 — Component: .env-hatch

ENVIRONMENT TEXTURE

USE. Diagonal stripes on the diagram panel. Reads as a road, a workbench, a construction site — use when the metaphor has a physical surface (streets, factories, workshops).

```
<div class="dg env-hatch"> ... </div>
```

ENVIRONMENT · HATCH



- ① **Note.** Stronger personality than dots; pair with solid (never dashed) content boxes so the stripes do not fight the content.

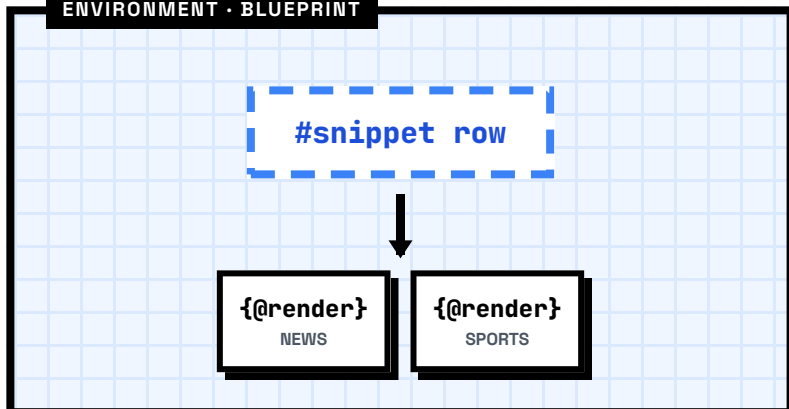
3 — Component: .env-blueprint

ENVIRONMENT TEXTURE

USE. A blue-tinted drafting grid. Signals plans, blueprints, templates, definitions — anything that stamps out instances (snippets, classes, component definitions).

```
<div class="dg env-blueprint"> ... </div>
```

ENVIRONMENT · BLUEPRINT



① **Note.** Dashed blue borders read as “the plan”; solid black boxes below read as “the built thing”. Keep that contrast.

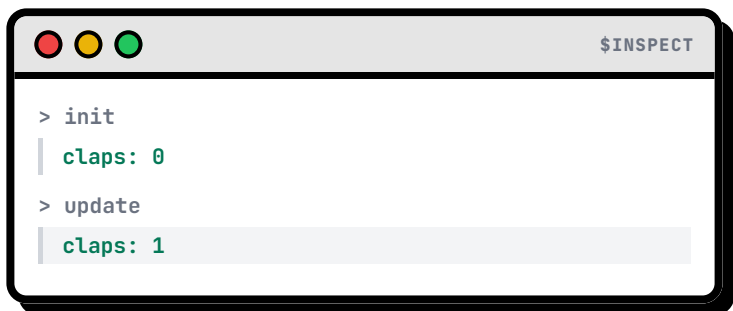
4 — Component: .console

OBJECT TERMINAL

USE. A developer terminal window: traffic-light bar, title, mono log lines with a highlighted entry. Grounds anything that reports, logs, or inspects (`$inspect`, console debugging, devtools). Print-safe light version of the dark `.terminal` in `diagrams.css`.

```
<div class="console"><div class="console-bar"><div class="console-dot r"></div><div class="console-dot y"></div><div class="console-dot g"></div><span class="console-title">devtools</span></div><div class="console-body">...</div></div>
```

OBJECT · CONSOLE



① **Note.** Use `.console-hl` on the line that changed — the highlight is where the eye should land.

5 — Component: .paper

OBJECT PAGE

USE. A printed page or newspaper: masthead rule plus mono body. For anything printed, rendered, or published — DOM output, batched updates, editions. `.paper.old` (dashed, gray) is yesterday's edition: stale output, superseded values.

```
<div class="paper"><div class="paper-mast">National  
Times</div><div class="paper-body">DOM: 5</div></div>  
<div class="paper old">...</div>
```

OBJECT · PAPER



① **Note.** Fresh vs old side by side is a ready-made staleness contrast — batching, caching, derived values.

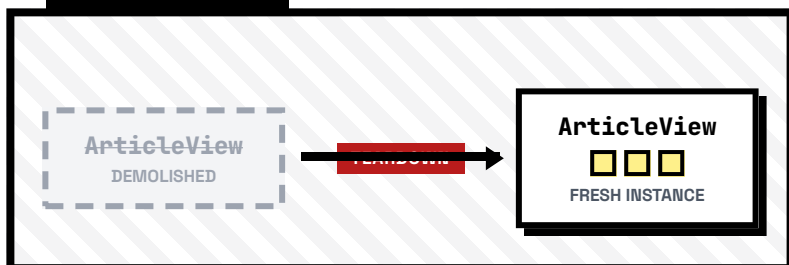
6 — Component: .bldg

OBJECT INSTANCE

USE. A building unit with lit windows: a component instance, an object, anything that gets constructed and can be demolished. Pair with `.ghost` + `.strike` for the destroyed version — the wrecking-ball move.

```
<div class="bldg"><div class="bldg-name">ArticleView</div><div class="bldg-wins"><div class="bldg-win"></div><div class="bldg-win"></div></div><div class="bldg-sub">draft inside</div></div>
```

OBJECT · BUILDING



① **Note.** Lit windows = live state inside. A demolished building with dark windows needs no extra caption.

7 — Component: .tray

OBJECT QUEUE

USE. A dashed inbox holding `.tray-item`s: pending writes, queued tasks, waiting subscribers. The queue makes “not yet processed” physically visible — the gap between write and apply.

```
<div class="tray"><span class="tray-label">press  
queue</span><br/><span class="tray-item">claps =  
5</span><span class="tray-item">title =  
...</span></div>
```

OBJECT · TRAY



① **Note.** Items sitting in the tray while output stays stale is the whole story of batching — say it with placement, not paragraphs.

8 — Component: .stamp

DEVICE VERDICT

USE. A rotated tag for verdicts and emphasis: APPROVED, DEPRECATED, SURVIVED, RESET. The tilt makes it read as a physical stamp pressed onto the page — the card's verdict in one word.

```
<span class="stamp red">deprecated</span>
```

DEVICE · STAMP

on:click

DEPRECATED

onclick

STANDARD

① **Note.** One stamp per scene, two at most. A third stamp turns the card into a passport page.

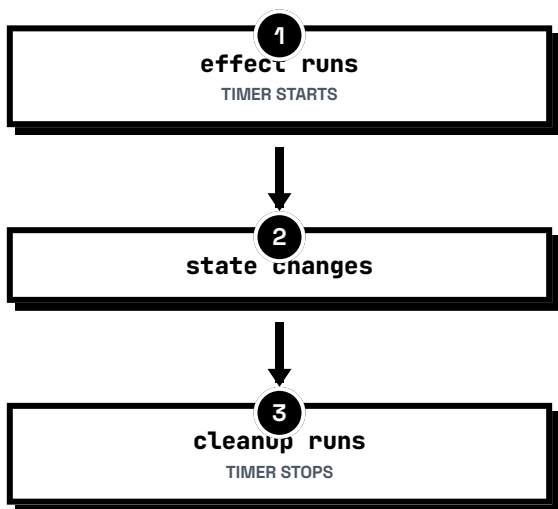
9 — Component: .badge

DEVICE SEQUENCE

USE. A numbered circle pinned to a step: chronological flows, lifecycle stages, pipelines. The number does the ordering so the layout can relax.

```
<div style="position:relative;"><span class="badge" style="position:absolute; top:-11px; left:50%; transform:translateX(-50%);">1</span> ... </div>
```

DEVICE · BADGE



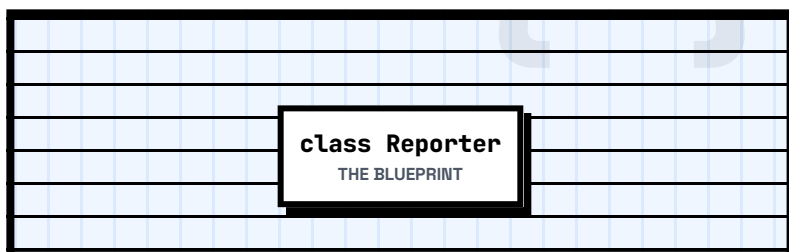
- ① **Note.** Overlap the badge onto the box border; the white ring keeps it readable over any background.

10 — Component: .watermark

DEVICE ATMOSPHERE

USE. A giant faded glyph behind the content: `{ }` for scopes, `λ` for functions, a rune for its own card. Adds depth and personality at zero cost to clarity. Parent panel needs `position:relative`.

```
<div class="dg" style="position:relative;"><span  
class="watermark">{ }</span> ... </div>
```



① **Note.** Keep opacity near 0.07: visible on screen, a whisper in print. Always behind the content, never beside it.

11 — Component: .ghost

DEVICE ABSENCE

USE. A dead, destroyed, or ignored element: dashed gray border, no shadow, washed content. Pair with `.strike` on its name. This is how a diagram shows what did NOT happen — the crossed-out expectation.

```
<div class="bldg ghost"><div class="bldg-name  
strike">old value</div></div>
```

DEVICE · GHOST

WHAT YOU EXPECTED



WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENS



① **Note.** Ghost plus lane-label is the violation genre in two lines: the wrong expectation gets a visible grave.

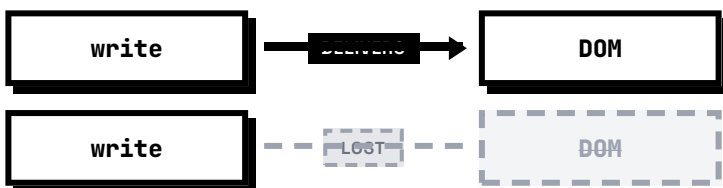
12 — Component: .wire

DEVICE CONNECTOR

USE. A connector with an inline label tag and an optional drawn arrowhead: every arrow in a scene is an operation, and the tag names it. `.head` adds the arrowhead, `.down` turns it vertical, `.dashed` makes it a dead or scheduled link. Tag variants: default black, `.red` (destructive), `.yel` (highlight), `.mut` (inactive).

```
<div class="wire head"><span class="wire-  
tag">patch</span></div>  
<div class="wire down head"></div>
```

DEVICE · WIRE



① **Note.** The tag floats on the wire and interrupts it — the reader reads the operation while following the flow.

13 — Component: .zone

DEVICE REGION

USE. A named dashed region grouping elements: retained scope, error boundary, safe area, old way. Zones answer “where does this live?” — the fog genre’s best friend.

```
<div class="zone"><span class="zone-label">retained  
scope</span> ... </div>
```

DEVICE · ZONE

createCounter() · outer function

RETAINED SCOPE

count = 0

return

count++

- ① **Note.** The label sits on the zone’s border, like a sign on a fence — the region reads as a place, not a rectangle.

14 — Component: .lane

DEVICE COMPARISON

USE. A comparison row with a color-coded semantic label: **.ok** green (what works), **.bad** red (what fails), **.info** blue (the new way), **.mut** gray (the inactive way). Lanes are the skeleton of the violation and choice genres — identical chrome, one differing fate.

```
<div class="lane"><span class="lane-label  
bad">without cleanup · timers pile up</span> ... </div>
```

DEVICE · LANE

WITHOUT CLEANUP · TIMERS PILE UP

timer 1

timer 2

timer 3

WITH CLEANUP · ONE AT A TIME

timer 1

timer 2

timer 3

- ① **Note.** The label carries the rule, the boxes carry the evidence. Color-code the labels, keep the boxes neutral.